

Americas



Passenger pigeon

A flock of this once-common species could contain 2 million birds.



Laysan rail

This bird's Hawaiian habitat was taken over by non-native rats and rabbits.



Xerces blue butterfly

Its habitat of sand dunes in California was replaced by growing cities.



Golden toad

Its extinction may have been caused by habitat loss or a fungal disease.



Labrador duck

Its extinction was not caused by hunting, as its flesh reportedly tasted horrible!



Pinta Island tortoise

The last tortoise on this Galápagos island, Lonesome George, died in 2012.



Red-bellied gracile opossum

Its Argentinian forest habitat was turned into grazing land for cattle.



Falkland Island wolf

Hunted to extinction by human settlers.

Eurasia



Great auk

Hunted by humans mainly for its meat and feathers.



Eurasian aurochs

Massive cattle species wiped out by overhunting.



Yunnan lake newt

Became extinct due to the introduction of exotic fish and frogs.



Baiji

River dolphin that died out when its habitat was taken over by industry.



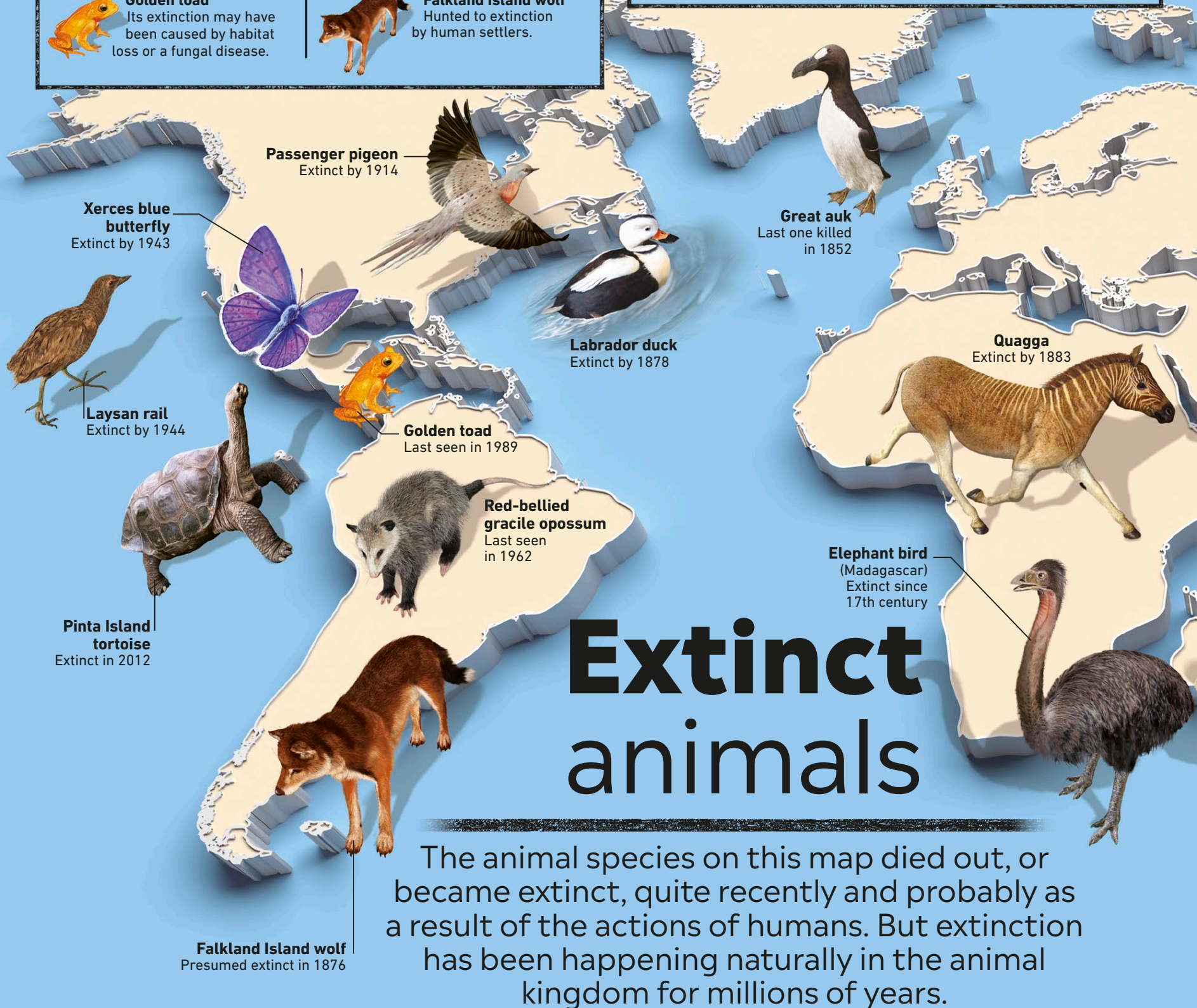
Japanese sea lion

Killed by fishermen to prevent them from competing for fish.



Woolly mammoth

Lost much of its habitat when the Ice Age ended.



Extinct animals

The animal species on this map died out, or became extinct, quite recently and probably as a result of the actions of humans. But extinction has been happening naturally in the animal kingdom for millions of years.